

Firearms Trace Data: Delaware - 2023

Data Source: Firearms Tracing System

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

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ATF Firearms Trace Data Disclaimer

Firearm traces are designed to assist law enforcement authorities in conducting investigations by tracking the sale and possession of specific firearms. Law enforcement agencies may request firearms traces for any investigative reason, and those reasons are not necessarily reported to the federal government. Not all firearms used in crime are traced and not all firearms traced are used in crime.

Firearms selected for tracing are not chosen for purposes of determining which types, makes or models of firearms are used for illicit purposes. The firearms selected do not constitute a random sample and should not be considered representative of the larger universe of all firearms used by criminals, or any subset of that universe. Firearms are normally traced to the first retail seller, and sources reported for firearms traced do not necessarily represent the sources or methods by which firearms in general are acquired for use in crime.

Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced in Delaware in Calendar Year 2023

1,434

Firearm Types with a Delaware Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Pistols	1,076
Rifles	139
Revolvers	120
Shotguns	82
Unknown Types	8
Derringers	7
Receivers/Frames	2

Top Calibers Reported on Firearm Traces with a Delaware Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

9mm	703
.22 Cal	125
.40 Cal	114
.380 Cal	95
.45 Cal	78
12GA	68

.38 Cal	47
MULTI	25
.357 Cal	23
5.56mm	22

NOTE: There were 129 additional traces that were associated with other calibers. There were five traces with an unknown caliber.

Top Categories Reported on Firearm Traces with a Delaware Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Firearm Under Investigation	564
Possession of Weapon	423
Found Firearm	93
Carrying Concealed Weapon	70
Suicide	66
Family Offense	63
Aggravated Assault	34
Homicide	20
Dangerous Drugs	18
Robbery	14

NOTE: There were 69 additional traces that were associated with other categories.

Top 15 Source States for Firearms with a Delaware Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Delaware	749
Pennsylvania	131
Maryland	38
Georgia	34
Virginia	30
Florida	26
North Carolina	25
South Carolina	12
Texas	9
California	7
Ohio	7
West Virginia	6
Mississippi	5
New Jersey	5
Indiana	4
Kansas	4
Wisconsin	4

NOTE: An additional 22 states and the District of Columbia accounted for 43 other traces. The source state was identified in 1,139 total traces.

Time-To-Crime Rates for Firearms with a Delaware Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Under 3 Months	98
3 Months to Under 7 Months	82
7 Months to Under 1 Year	78
1 Year to Under 2 Years	181
2 Years to Under 3 Years	188
3 Years and Over	511

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 Delaware Average Time-to-Crime: **6.43 Years**

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 National Average Time-to-Crime: **6.76 Years**

Age of Possessors for Firearms with a Delaware Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

17 and Under	80
18 to 21	156
22 to 24	150
25 to 30	242
31 to 40	266
41 to 50	154
Over 50	145

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 Delaware Average Age of Possessor: **33 Years**

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 National Average Age of Possessor: **35 Years**

Top Recovery Cities for Firearms with a Delaware Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Wilmington	408
Newark	168
New Castle	165
Dover	157
Seaford	55
Bear	54
Millsboro	45
Milford	42
Townsend	36
Laurel	30

NOTE: There were 37 additional municipalities that accounted for 274 other traces.

Analytical Criteria Used to Compile the Enclosed Statistics

Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced

- Includes traces with a recovery state of Delaware. Traces in which the recovery state was not provided were included when the requesting agency state was equal to Delaware.
- Includes Firearms Recovered and Traced between 1/1/2023 –12/31/2023 or, if the recovery date was blank, firearms with trace entry dates between 1/1/2023 –12/31/2023.

- Duplicate traces, Firearms Not Recovered, Gun Buyback and Firearms Turned In are not included in this figure.
- Data was extracted from the Firearms Tracing System (FTS) on April 10, 2024.
- All traces may not have been submitted or completed at the time of this study.

Firearm Types and Calibers with a Delaware Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.

Top Categories Reported on Firearm Traces with a Delaware Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.

Top Source States for Firearms with a Delaware Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Traces must identify a purchaser and the state in which the final dealer is located.

Time-to-Crime Rates for Firearms with a Delaware Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Traces must identify a purchaser.
- Time-to-Crime was calculated for those traces in which the purchase date could be subtracted from the recovery date.

Age of Possessors for Firearms with a Delaware Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Includes traces that provide a possessor and the possessor's date of birth.
- Possessor's age is calculated by subtracting the possessor's date of birth from the recovery date.

Top Recovery Cities for Firearms with a Delaware Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Includes traces with a recovery city or, if the recovery city was not provided, traces requested by agencies with jurisdiction only within that city.

[View All 2023 Firearms Trace Data](#)

Last updated: December 9, 2024